VITIS
Vine
VITACEAE

Genus of deciduous, woody-stemmed, tendril climbers, grown for their foliage and fruits (grapes), which are produced in bunches. Fully hardy. Prefers fertile, well-drained, chalky soil and sun or partial shade. Produces the best fruits and fall leaf-color when planted in a warm situation. Propagate by hardwood cuttings in late fall.

V. aconitifolia. See *Ampelopsis aconitifolia*.

V. amurensis (Amur grape). Vigorous, deciduous, woody-stemmed, tendril climber. H 20ft (6m). Has dark green, 3- or 5-lobed leaves, 5–12in (12–30cm) long, that mature to red and purple in fall. Produces inconspicuous flowers through the summer, followed, in late summer and fall, by tiny, black fruits. Z4–8

***V.* 'Brant'** (illus. p.208). Deciduous, woody-stemmed, tendril climber. H to 22ft (7m) or more. Has leaves that are lobed, toothed, 4–9in (10–22cm) long and bright green. In fall, they mature to brown-red, except for the veins. Inconspicuous flowers are borne in summer, followed by green or purple fruits. Z4–8

V. coignetiae (Crimson glory vine) illus. p.209.

V. henryana. See *Parthenocissus henryana*.

V. heterophylla. See *Ampelopsis brevipedunculata* var. *maximowiczii*.

V. quinquefolia. See *Parthenocissus quinquefolia*.

V. striata. See *Cissus striata*.

V. thomsonii. See *Cayratia thomsonii*.

V. vinifera (Grape vine). **'Purpurea'** illus. p.210. **'Spetchley Red'** is a woody climber. H 22ft (7m). Has rounded, 3- to 5-lobed, toothed, mid-green leaves, turning crimson-red in fall. Produces small, unpalatable, spherical purple grapes in fall. Z6–10

VRIESEA
BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming, mostly epiphytic perennials, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Frost tender. Needs a position in partial shade and a rooting medium of equal parts humus-rich soil and either sphagnum moss, bark, or plastic chips used for orchid culture. Using soft water, water moderately when in growth, sparingly at other times, and from mid-spring to mid-fall keep rosette centers filled with water. Propagate plants by offsets or seed in spring. See also feature panel p.471.

V. fenestralis. Evergreen, epiphytic perennial with dense, funnel-shaped rosettes. H and S 12–16in (30–40cm). Pale green leaves, with dark lines and cross-bands, are very broadly strap-shaped and arching or rolled under at tips. In summer, flat racemes of tubular, yellowish-green flowers, with green bracts, are borne above the foliage. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

V. fosteriana. Evergreen, epiphytic perennial with dense, funnel-shaped rosettes. H and S 2ft (60cm) or more. Broadly strap-shaped, arching, yellowish- to deep green leaves, are cross-banded with reddish-brown, particularly beneath. In summer–fall, flat spikes of tubular, pale yellow or greenish-yellow flowers, with brownish-red tips, are produced well above the foliage. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

V. hieroglyphica (King of the bromeliads). Evergreen perennial with dense, funnel-shaped rosettes. H and S 2–3ft (60cm–1m). Produces broadly strap-shaped, arching, yellowish-green leaves, cross-banded and checkered with dark brownish-green. In summer, bears panicles of tubular, yellow flowers well above the leaves. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

V. platynema. Evergreen, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Broadly strap-shaped, mid- to light green leaves, with purple tips, form dense rosettes. In summer, produces flat racemes of tubular, green-and-yellow flowers, with red or yellow bracts. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

V. psittacina. Evergreen, spreading, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H and S 16–24in (40–60cm). Has dense rosettes of strap-shaped, arching, pale green leaves. Flat spikes of tubular, yellow flowers with green tips, emerging from red-and-yellow or red-and-green bracts, are borne in summer–fall. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

V. splendens (Flaming sword; illus. p.471). Evergreen, basal-rosetted, epiphytic perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Has dense rosettes of strap-shaped, arching, olive-green leaves, with purple to reddish-brown cross-bands. In summer and fall, bears flat, sword-shaped racemes of tubular, yellow flowers, between bright red bracts. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

x ***Vuylstekeara* Cambria gx 'Lensing's Favorite'.** See x *Oncidopsis* Cambria gx 'Lensing's Favorite'.

WACHENDORFIA
HAEMODORACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, deciduous or evergreen, tuberous perennials, grown for their large, terminal panicles of star-shaped, yellow flowers. Half hardy. Requires a position in full sun and in moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall or spring.

W. thyrsiflora. Clump-forming perennial. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Shallowly cup-shaped, yellow to orange flowers are borne in dense panicles in early summer. Mid-green leaves are narrowly sword-shaped, pleated, and rather coarse. Z10–11

WAHLENBERGIA
CAMPANULACEAE

Genus of mat-forming to upright annuals and perennials, grown for their bell-shaped flowers. Borderline fully hardy to half hardy. Needs a sheltered site, partial shade, and well-drained, peaty, sandy soil. Useful for an alpine house. Propagate by seed in fall.

W. albomarginata (New Zealand bluebell). Basal-rosetted, rhizomatous perennial. H and S 6in (15cm) or more. In summer, slender stems bear a bell-shaped, clear blue flower that opens flat. Has tufts of narrowly elliptic to ovate, mid-green leaves. Suits a rock garden. (borderline)

W. congesta, syn. *W. saxicola* var. *congesta*. Mat-forming, creeping, rhizomatous perennial. H 3in (7cm), S 4in (10cm). Has small, rounded or spoon-shaped, mid-green leaves and, in summer, bell-shaped, lavender-blue or white flowers held singly on wiry stems. Z9–11

W. pumilo. See *Edraianthus pumilo*.

W. saxicola* var. *congesta. See *W. congesta*.

W. serpyllifolia. See *Edraianthus serpyllifolius*.

WALDSTEINIA
ROSACEAE

Genus of rhizomatous, herbaceous perennials, grown for their foliage and flowers. Provides good groundcover. Fully hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by division in early spring.

W. ternata, syn. *W. trifolia*, illus. p.372.

W. trifolia. See *W. ternata*.

WASHINGTONIA
ARECACEAE/PALMAE

Genus of evergreen, single-stemmed palms, grown for their stately appearance. Frost tender. Grow in fertile, well-drained soil and in full sun. Water containerized specimens freely in summer, moderately at other times. Remove skirt of persistent, dead leaves regularly as they are a fire risk. Propagate by seed in spring at not less than 75°F (24°C). Red spider mite may be a nuisance.

W. filifera (Desert fan palm). Fast-growing, evergreen palm. H and S to 80ft (25m). Has fan-shaped, long-stalked, gray-green leaves, each lobe with a filamentous tip. Long-stalked clusters of tiny, creamy-white flowers are borne in summer and berrylike, black fruits in winter. Z10–12 (min. 46–50°F/8–10°C)

W. robusta (Thread palm) illus. p.451.

WATSONIA
IRIDACEAE

Genus of cormous perennials, *Gladiolus*-like in overall appearance, although flowers are more tubular. Frost hardy to half hardy. Needs an open, sunny position and light, well-drained soil. In fall, plant 4–6in (10–15cm) deep; protect with bracken, loose peat, or similar during first winter, if frost is expected. Feed with slow-acting fertilizer, such as bonemeal, in summer. Leave corms undisturbed to form clumps. Propagate by seed in fall.

W. beatricis. See *W. pillansii*.

W. borbonica, syn. *W. pyramidata*, illus. p.386.

W. fourcadei. Clump-forming, summer-flowering corm. H to 5ft (1.5m), S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Sword-shaped, erect leaves are mostly basal. Bears a dense spike of tubular, salmon-red flowers, each 3–3½in (8–9cm) long and with 6 lobes. Z9–11

W. meriania illus. p.385.

W. pillansii, syn. *W. beatricis*, illus. p.386.

W. pyramidata. See *W. borbonica*.

Wattakaka sinensis. See *Dregea sinensis*.

WEIGELA
CAPRIFOLIACEAE/DIERVILLACEAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs, grown for their showy, bell- to funnel-shaped flowers. Good for a mixed or shrub border, or for open woodland. Fully hardy. Prefers sunny, fertile soil. To maintain vigor, prune out a few older branches to ground level, after flowering each year. Straggly, old plants may be pruned hard in spring (although this will lose one season's flowers). Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

***W.* 'Bristol Ruby'.** Vigorous, upright shrub. H 8ft (2.5m), S 6ft (2m). Deep red flowers open from darker buds amid ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves in late spring and early summer. Z4–8

***W.* 'Candida'.** Bushy shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Pure white flowers are borne in late spring and early summer. Leaves are ovate, toothed, and bright green. Z4–8

***W.* Carnaval ('Courtalor').** Vigorous, upright shrub. H 8ft (2.5m), S 6ft (2m). Has ovate, dark green leaves. In late spring and early summer, bears bell-shaped, pale pink, white, and dark pink flowers. Z4–8

W. coraeensis. Upright to spreading shrub. H and S 11½ft (3.5m). Has shiny, ovate, toothed leaves. In early summer, bears bell-shaped, white or pale pink flowers, aging to carmine-red. Z4–8

W. florida. Deciduous, arching shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Bears deep pink flowers, pale pink to white inside, in late spring and early summer. Ovate, toothed leaves are mid-green. Z4–8. **'Alexandra'** see *W.f.* Wine and Roses ('Alexandra').

'Variegata' see *W.* 'Nana Variegata'

Wine and Roses ('Alexandra') (syn. *W.f.* 'Alexandra'), H 4–5½ft (1.2–1.6m), S 5½–6ft (1.6–1.8m), has dark red-brown leaves and produces abundant, bright purplish pink flowers.

***W.* 'Looymansii Aurea'** illus. p.154.

W. middendorffiana illus. p.159.

***W.* 'Nana Variegata'**, syn. *W. florida* 'Variegata', illus. p.152.

***W. praecox* 'Variegata'.** See *W.* 'Praecox Variegata'.

***W.* 'Praecox Variegata'**, syn. *W. praecox* 'Variegata', *W.* 'Variegata'. Upright shrub. H 8ft (2.5m), S 6ft (2m). Produces ovate, toothed, bright green leaves with broad creamy-white margins. Bears fragrant, pink flowers, marked inside with yellow, in late spring. Z4–8

***W.* 'Red Prince'.** Upright, rounded shrub. H and S 5½ft (1.6m). Has reddish brown branches and large, narrowly ovate leaves, with purplish red tints. In late spring, produces bell-shaped, lightly fragrant, dark red flowers. Z4–8

***W.* 'Variegata'.** See *W.* 'Praecox Variegata'.

Weingartia neocumingii. See *Rebutia neocumingii*.

WELDENIA
COMMELINACEAE

Genus of one species of summer-flowering, tuberous perennial, grown for its cup-shaped, white flowers. Frost hardy. Needs sun and gritty, well-drained soil. Keep dry from fall until growth